

management, task management, workflow processes, time tracking, document management, reports, a calendar and many other features. It is available as a community version (free) and a paid version.

Drawing: GNU Image Manipulation Program (the GIMP) can do all kinds of image manipulation and is the best alternative to Adobe Photoshop. Dia, a diagram editor, can be used for drawing diagrams, as an alternative to Microsoft Visio. And Inkscape easily replaces Adobe Illustrator and CorelDraw.

Science: SciLab is the best alternative for MatLab.

Antivirus: ClamWin is an antivirus software with a slick design and is easy to manage.

Calendar: For those who need calendar support, Sunbird provides an excellent calendar for Linux distros. It is easy to use and master.

Animation: Blender is great for 3D animation and is the best replacement for the Maya package. There are many movies that have been made or rendered using Blender.

Audio and video: Playing audio and video on the Windows platform means installing many software packages for different formats. VLC is the solution for all requirements. It supports many audio and video formats and can play back

almost all audio and video files. It is simple to use and has a minimalist design. It can also be used for various streaming protocols and for media conversion. Audacity is another tool used for audio editing, as a replacement for Adobe Audition.

Utilities: For torrent downloads, one should try the lightweight BitTorrent client. For compressing, 7-Zip is an excellent option. For FTP, the Filezilla client is a good option.

Database: All major database software like MySQL or PostgreSQL come free as community editions, and can replace the costly Microsoft SQL Server and Oracle Server.

Virtualisation: Virtual Box is desktop virtualisation software that can be used in place of VMware.

So, basically, for every proprietary software, there is an open source software option, which is usually distributed free as a community edition, but may have a paid version too. It's simply a matter of searching for what you want. **END** 

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